

AUTOMOBILE

CADILLAC VTOL

GM showed off a bunch of cool Cadillac vehicles at CES 2021, both real and concept. However, one in particular really stood out, the single-seater VTOL craft. A Vertical Take-Off and Landing Vehicle that has been designed to ferry people from rooftop to rooftop in cities. The VTOL is an all-electric single-seater vehicle, that can travel between skyscrapers at speeds of 90 km/h. The target demographic for the VTOL are the crowd that need to quickly shuttle between locations in major metropolitan areas. This method would allow them to completely bypass ground traffic. However, there's still the fact that it only seats one; you'd need a large vertiport.



The Cadillac VTOL is GM's first aerial vehicle, and they've stated that they're focusing more on electric and even personal air travel vehicles in the coming future. While still a concept, GM has

expressed that it might look into actually putting the VTOL into production. They even released a few specifications about the VTOL, including the fact that it's powered by a 90 kWh lithium-ion battery and four rotors, all electric powered as well. The VTOL can also communicate wirelessly, including air vehicle to air vehicle communication. Probably to avoid mid-air collisions? We hope so.

MERCEDES-BENZ MBUX HYPERSCREEN

Mercedes-Benz is giving its next-gen electric cars a fancy new infotainment system dubbed the MBUX Hyperscreen. What makes the MBUX Hyperscreen special is that it's a single screen that runs from one end of the dashboard to the other. The Mercedes-Benz EQS sedan will be the first car to debut the MBUX Hyperscreen dashboard, and that's expected to start production later this year. The MBUX stands for the "Mercedes-Benz User Experience", and was launched back in 2018. It was used in everything, from their



luxury cars to their delivery vans. The Hyperscreen however has little to nothing in common with the MBUX that launched 3 years ago. The "new" MBUX is a 56-inch curved OLED display, the largest in any production car, and is powered by eight CPU cores, 24GB of RAM, 46.6GB/s of RAM memory bandwidth and 12 actuators for haptic feedback.

The screen itself is double coated to reduce reflection and make it easier to clean. Brightness automatically adjusts itself using an inbuilt camera and light sensor.

The screen is so massive, it can be divided into sections for the driver and the co-passenger. The co-passenger side can even be turned-off when no one is seated. The UI has been completely overhauled, and designers created the new UI based on research and most-used functions. To add to that, the MBUX Hyperscreen itself can use AI to predict what function the user wants. 

EVERYTHING ELSE

SKYDIO X2

Autonomous drone startup Skydio entered the commercial market this CES with their brand new X2 model. The Skydio X2 is their first non-con-

sumer model, targeted at governments agencies, the military, and basically organisations and services involving aerial surveillance and security. The foldable autonomous drone comes



with a host of features to help it excel in this field, including a built-in infrared thermal camera. The X2 has folding arms, which is a first for the company. While it's not uncommon to see folded drones, Skydio found it a challenge to make it work with their autonomous flight capabilities. In addition to the infrared thermal camera, the X2 comes with GPS-powered night flight, visible light and IR illuminators for flying in the dark, an enterprise-grade controller with a built-in touchscreen and the battery life has also been extended to 35 minutes from the Skydio 2's 23 minutes. The X2 will also have a 3D scan feature, which will aid it when it comes to inspecting structures or investigating crime scenes.